Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 4 – Push Day (Hypertrophy & Shoulder Development)

Objective

Maximize chest, shoulders, and triceps hypertrophy while protecting your shoulder and improving pressing mechanics.

Order	Exercise	Sets	Reps	RPE	Rest
1	Incline Dumbbell Press	4	8–10	8	2 min
2	Machine Chest Press	3	10–12	8	90 s
3	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press	3	8–10	8	90 s
4A	Cable Lateral Raise	3	12–15	9	—
4B	Face Pull	3	12–15	8	60 s
5	Low-to-High Cable Fly	3	12–15	8	60 s
6A	Overhead Rope Extension	3	10–12	8	—
6B	Rope Pushdown	3	10–12	8	60 s
7	Push-ups (AMRAP, stop 1 rep before failure)	2	—	—	60 s

Why No Dips?

Dips previously irritated your shoulder. They are omitted until you can press pain-free for several weeks. If symptoms remain absent, dips can be reintroduced gradually.

Exercise Order

Large compound presses come first for maximum output. Isolation work follows when fatigue is higher because it produces less systemic fatigue while still stimulating muscle growth.

Coaching Cues

Keep shoulder blades stable during pressing, control the lowering phase, and avoid locking out aggressively on triceps work.

Common Mistakes

Using excessive weight on lateral raises, flaring elbows excessively during presses, and turning cable flyes into presses.

Progression

When all prescribed sets reach the top of the rep range with 1–2 RIR, increase load by the smallest available increment.